

pleasing to the eyes. The combination of the *Qinghua* with the bean celadon glaze was called the "underglaze tricolours."

Compared to the style of roughness and boldness of the five-colours made in the Jiajing and Wanli reigns, the Kangxi five-colours stressed much more on excellent strokes and magnificent colour characterised by vigorous writing, forceful lines, thick pigment and curved lines, with ups and downs of figures, clothes, mountains, rocks, trees, flowers, birds, animals, houses and furniture. The writing, light and heavy, slow and quick, robust and soft, was in perfect harmony. While drawing the *linglong* rock, for example, one stroke drew out the outer sketch and added some circles inside, and took the advantage of folded lines to express the features of transparency, rugosity and barrenness of rocks, with a strong contrast of colours. Various kinds of highly pure and strong transparent colours were applied inside the patterns of single lines, full of magnificence and rhythm. Gold colour was also applied to harmonise various colours, making the product splendid additionally. The figures were succinct and general. The facial features of the figures were expressed with only few strokes, appearing slightly iridescent on face. The hair bun of lady and the boot of warrior were all painted by a lump of black hue, full of decoration. The layout was mainly flat surface, and few profound scenery with gradations; and the patterns were exaggerated and out of shape, frequently formed by stylisation of points, lines and flats, such as the parallel lines on tree trunks and the crowded points on the *linglong* rock. The painters were full of imagination while applying colours.

Single tricolour (or single sancai) was made by incising patterns on a body and burning into the unglazed body at high temperature, then filling three colours, yellow, green and purple, inside and outside the drawn pattern lines and lastly putting it in the kiln for baking at low temperature. It was called "single tricolour" because of its shortage of red colour in the picture. In the single tricolour porcelain, there were also two kinds of patterns: incising and painting, such as the novel and unconventional technique of decoration used in the bowl decorated with incised dragon and painted peony and butterfly pattern, in which the double dragons and a fire ball were at the first incised, burned into the unglazed body at high temperature, then sketched out the peony sprays and butterflies on the dragons patterns with black pigment, and then filled with yellow, green and purple colours, and painted with lead glaze of low temperature as the white ground. The incised double dragons were lifelike and exquisite while the tricoloured flowers and butterflies were bold and rough and profound. The two methods and two kinds of patterns, false or true, visible or

invisible, highlighted with each other, providing a sense of solemnity, quietness and elegance.

The tiger-skin-like tricolour decoration was made by painting the glazes with yellow, green and purple colours into tiger-skin-like coloured patterns on an unglazed body, letting them spread freely so as to form a riot of glaze colours, full of the flavour of an abstract painting. There were also openwork utensils and sculptures created unconventionally.

In Kangxi Reign there were the decorations of the *Qinghua* patterns on the different colours ground such as the bean celadon glaze, the fragment (crackle) pattern glaze and the yellow glaze; of the five-colour patterns on the different colours ground such as the cream glaze, fragment pattern glaze and the bean celadon glaze; and of the purple-green coloured pattern in yellow ground and so on. Among the decorations, the five-colour pattern on red ground and the tricolour on black ground both were the preciouses and unique products rare to be found in the collection handed down from ancient times.

MONOCHROMIC GLAZE During Kangxi Reign the copper red glazed porcelain wares were re-produced, which had been almost lost ever since mid-term of the Ming Dynasty, of which the Lang (kiln) red and the bean red were the most precious. The glaze of Lang (kiln) red with ice crackle pattern was showy and beautiful in colour, transparent and glaring. Its typical utensils included the Guanyin (or Avalokitesvara) *Zun* and the gall-shaped vase. The bean-red glaze were called differently due to difference in colours, including the "big red robe (*dahongpao*)" for its clean, flawless, pure and brilliant colour; the "drunk beauty (*zuimeiren*)" for its freely spread deep red and light green speckles on the glazed surface; and the "peach blow (*Taohuapian*)" for its pale and soft glaze colour. The shape included the Taibai *Zun*, the willow-leaf vase, the chrysanthemum-petal vase and so on. The two kinds of red-glaze (Lang and Bean) utensils formed respectively elegant and noble, pretty and graceful styles.

In the colour glazes of high or low temperatures, there were also novel varieties, such as the coral red glaze, the rouge red glaze, the mirror black glaze, the sky-blue glaze, as well as traditional ones such as the underglaze tricolour, the shiny blue, the shiny red, the bean celadon, the peacock green and more, of which some were imposing and unsophisticated, some were bright and beautiful, and all were treasures of porcelains.

FENCAI AND ENAMEL Following the foreign missionaries'